TEMPLATE REPO

AI Design Harness

Check you're building the right thing, then design it the way your team would — with AI agents like Claude Code or Codex.

github.com/sadakoa/AI-design-harness

WHY

Why it exists

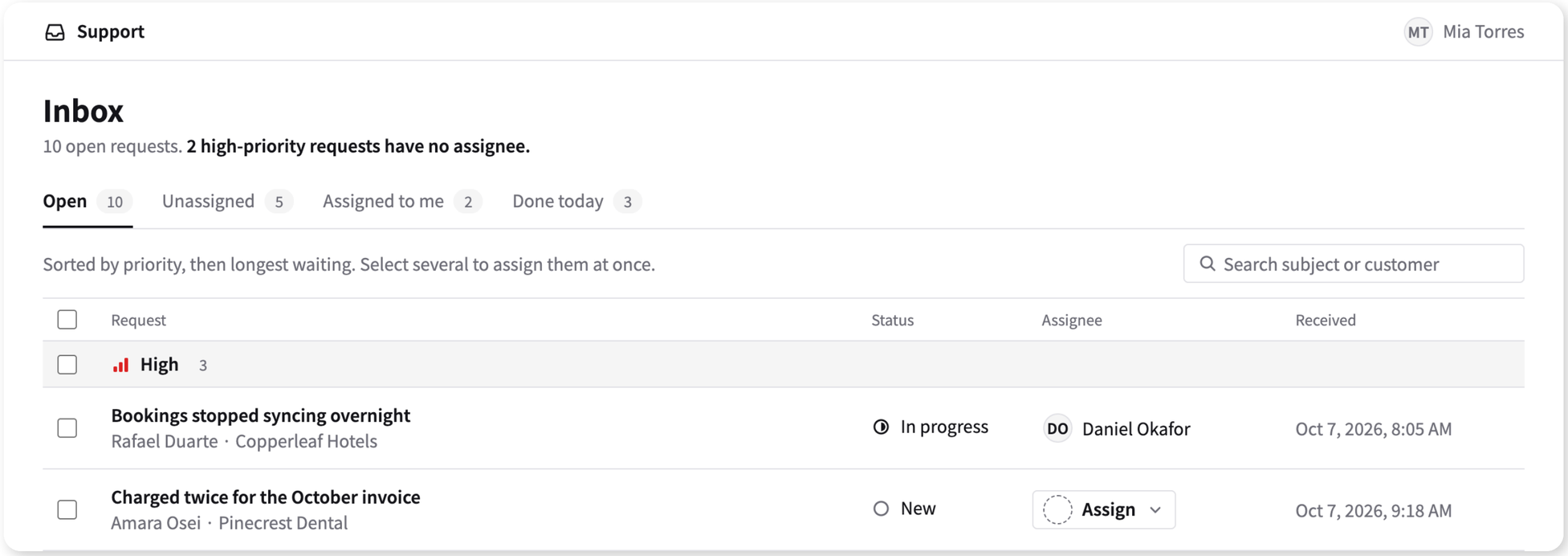
What we know about users and our design rules usually live in people's heads. The harness writes both down as small files, plus five skills (saved instructions like /frame) and a check script, so an AI agent can follow them.

Today	With the harness
❌ PRDs aren't checked against what we know	✅ Each PRD is checked against users and jobs
❌ One long doc mixes rules and one-off calls	✅ One question, one file
❌ Review comments are opinions, not rules	✅ Findings cite a rule, or say it's taste
❌ Lessons get lost in old chat threads	✅ Lessons flow back into product and design

WHAT YOU GET

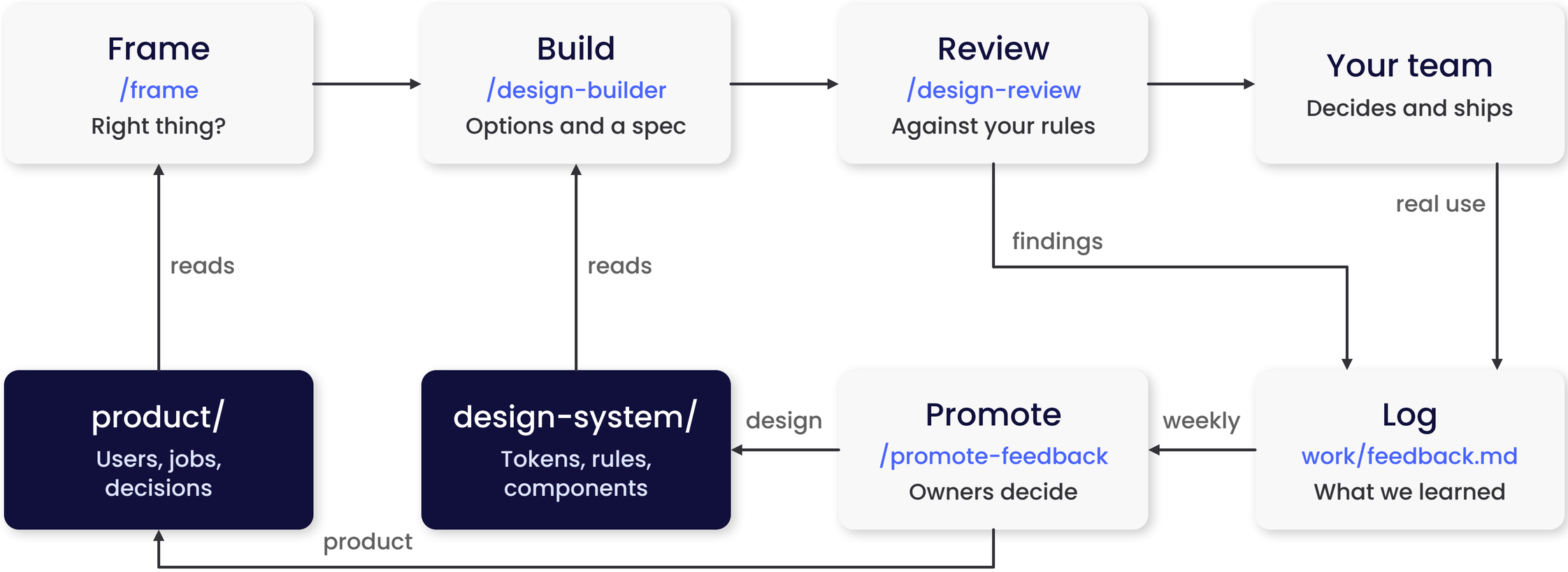
One proposal per screen or flow

A framing first, then about three clickable mockups, a recommendation and a spec on one HTML page, reviewed against your rules. Your team still decides, and builds it.



HOW IT FLOWS

From idea to what you learned



IDEA 1

Check the problem first

Before any design, /frame reads the PRD against product/: who it's for, which job, which decisions and constraints. Only a go reaches design.

go	decide first	stop
Support inbox For agents (U-01) who need to start with what's urgent (J-01). examples/prd/support-inbox.md	**Hand-off flow** Four screens, but no job covers its main goal yet. examples/prd/hand-off.md	**Community forum** Customer log-ins go against PD-01. Public posts break CON-02. examples/prd/community-forum.md

Every user and job in product/ is marked fact, hypothesis or open, so a PRD built on a guess gets caught.

IDEA 2

One question, one file

Each folder's INDEX.md says which file answers what, and what to read for each task.

product/ — what to build and why

- Who uses the product? users.md
- What are they trying to get done? jobs.md
- What do we call things? concepts.md
- What places are there? structure.md
- What limits us? constraints.md
- What do we stand for? principles.md
- What have we decided? decisions.md
- Where do the full docs live? sources.md

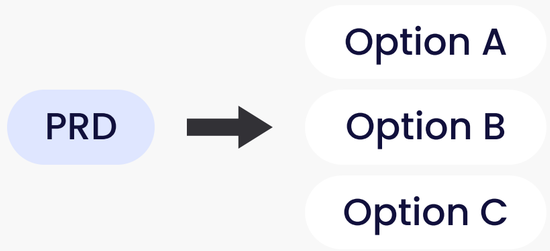
design-system/ — how it looks and works

- Which exact values do we use? tokens/
- What do we prioritize? principles.md
- What must we never do? rules.md
- How do we write UI text? writing.md
- Which component should I use? components/
- How do screens and flows fit? patterns/

IDEA 3

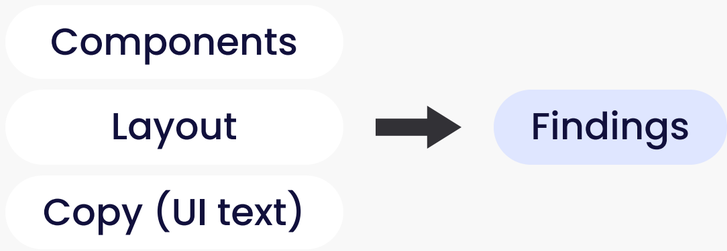
Build wide, review narrow

Build: explore options



Reads only what the framing points to, then builds options that differ in structure, for one screen or a whole flow.

Review: one area at a time

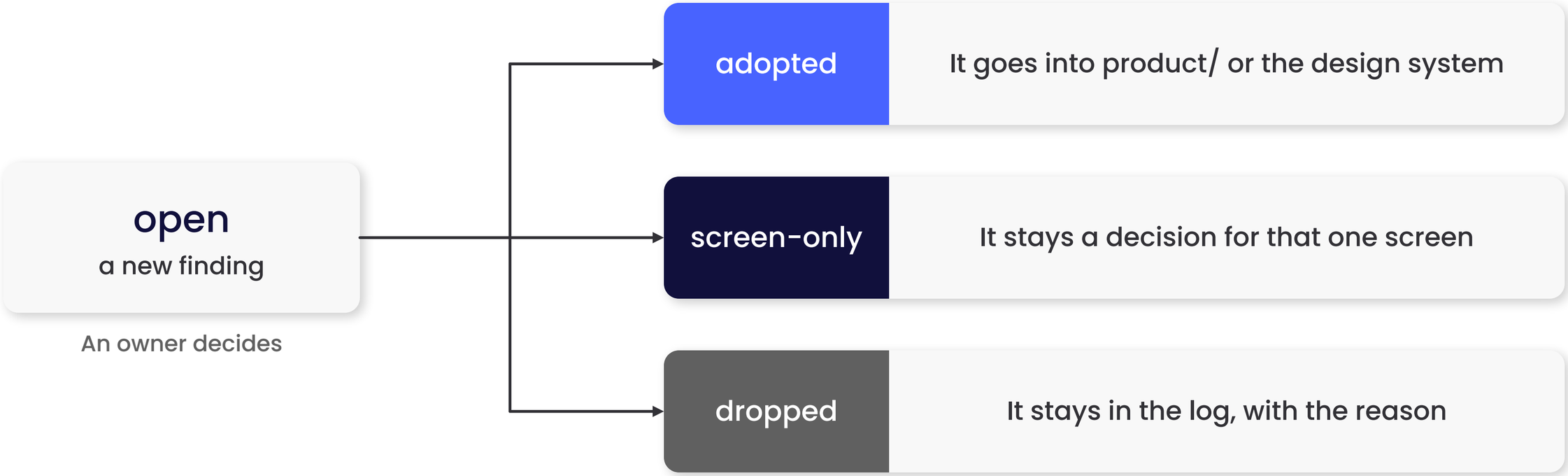


First: does it do the job? Then one area at a time. Findings cite a rule, or say it's taste.

IDEA 4

Feed what you learn back

Review findings and what real use shows go into one log, marked product (we built the wrong thing) or design (we built it the wrong way).



IN PRACTICE

Running it as a team

Owners are the people in CODEOWNERS: product owners for product/, design owners for design-system/.

First months	Then	Every week	Approvals
Only owners change product/ and the design system. Collect findings first.	Designers open PRs too. Start with UI text rules (writing.md).	An owner runs promote-feedback and decides.	With two or more owners, require their approval on GitHub.

NOT FOR	
	Screens unlike anything your product has today. The agent drafts options; someone with design experience should finish them.

START

Your first hour

For whoever sets it up. You need Claude Code or Codex, Node 20 or later, and git.

1. Use the repo as a template, or copy it into your product repo
2. Run /bootstrap on your product, with or without a design system
3. Check its drafts: users, jobs and your colors
4. Write a short PRD for one screen
5. Run /design-builder with it, then open the proposal

What's inside	
product/	What to build and why
design-system/	How it looks and works
work/	Framings and proposals
.claude/skills/	The five skills
scripts/	check and sync

Built on ideas from Canary's NestUI and Reiwa Travel's design-builder write-up

NEXT

Let's try it on one screen

The screen	The repo	The owner	Questions
[Screen to try]	[URL]	[Name]	[Channel]

[Name] writes a short PRD and runs /design-builder, which frames it first. Then we look at the framing and the proposal together. Anything that could apply elsewhere goes into the log.

APPENDIX

design-builder, step by step

01
Frame it
Runs /frame if there's no framing yet

02
Define the problem
Whose job (U-, J-) gets better, and how

03
Ask you
Only what changes the design (max 5)

04
Research
Approved screens first, then others

05
Explore
About three clickable mockups, for a screen or a flow

06
Recommend
Pick one, tie it to a principle

07
Write up
Everything on one HTML page

08
Review
Run design-review, then share it with you

APPENDIX

Reading by task

● always · ○ when relevant · design-system/INDEX.md. product/INDEX.md has its own: frame reads all of it.

File	Build	Components	Layout	Copy	Promote
components/inventory.md	○	●			
tokens/tokens.css	●	●	○		
tokens/tokens.json					○
foundations/principles.md	●	●	●	○	●
foundations/rules.md	●	●	●	●	●
foundations/writing.md	●			●	○
components/GUIDE.md	○	●			○
components/<name>.md	○	○			○
patterns/GUIDE.md	●		●		○
screens/README.md	●		○		
decisions.md					●

APPENDIX

What the check catches

npm run check runs on your machine and on every pull request.

File missing from an INDEX

In product/ or design-system/, or its Answers line doesn't match

Out of sync

Your code changed since the last npm run sync

Off-token CSS

Hard-coded colors or unknown CSS variables (R-01)

Duplicate IDs

Two entries share an ID: U-, J-, PD-, R-, FB- and the rest

Fact or guess?

A user or job not marked fact, hypothesis or open

Stale notes

Not reviewed in 90 days